



Assoc. Prof. Dr Çetin Karakaya

Mechanical Engineer · R&D and Innovation Project Manager · University-Industry Collaboration Strategist

E-mail: cetkarakaya@gmail.com Tel: +44 7359 747212 Location: Bexhill-on-Sea, East Sussex, England (10+ years)

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/drckarakaya (30K) · GitHub: github.com/tr2uk

ORCID: 0000-0002-9227-9170 · ResearcherID: GWZ-1741-2022 · Scopus: 57372110000 · SciProfiles: 4350364 · Scholar: 7BVbtHsAAAAJ

CORE EXPERTISE

Innovation & Strategy

R&D & Project Management

University-Industry Collaboration

Technology Transfer

Entrepreneurship Ecosystem

Patents & Intellectual Property

AI-Driven Business Models

Strategic Problem Solving

Engineering

Finite Element Analysis (FEA/CAE)

Composite & Sandwich Structures

Hydrogen Storage

Welding Technologies

Advanced Manufacturing

Materials Science

LANGUAGES

- Turkish – Native
- English – Professional Proficiency

INTERESTS

- Karate – 1st Dan Black Belt (Shotokan), 1986–1994, Turkey; numerous provincial/inter-provincial placements.
- MMA – Brown Belt, 2021–present, UK; medals at the Kent Open and regional championships.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

An Associate Professor and engineer with **25+ years** of experience across academia and industry in advanced manufacturing, materials and strategic R&D management. He approaches business and engineering problems with "Engineering Logic" (analytical · calculable · solvable); has managed **300+ industrial R&D projects**, provided technical consultancy to **100+ industrial and public organisations**, and coordinated **~30 R&D Project Markets** along the idea-to-product innovation path. He has lived in the UK for 10+ years. His goal: to build, with the participation of all university units, an applied innovation ecosystem in the TRNC that solves the region's real needs and generates international collaboration; to develop students into strong entrepreneurs for life after graduation and, by following their success stories, to bring the university know-how and international recognition in this field.

WHAT I CAN OFFER THE UNIVERSITY

- Establish and lead a **Rectorate-affiliated Entrepreneurship and Applied Innovation Unit**, open to all faculties; prepare students before graduation for real business life and entrepreneurship (with the AI-based "The Baird Effect" methodology).
- Institutionalise the "idea-to-product" path through **university-industry collaboration platforms and the R&D Project Market model**; turn the university into a regional innovation hub.
- Technology transfer & placing start-ups in the technopark** – companies addressing the region's needs, offering students internships/project-based experience; build international project and funding bridges, primarily with the UK.
- Region-focused applied projects** – engineering-based, measurable-output projects in water management, energy efficiency, agricultural technology and digital export.
- Develop **TRNC Technology Development Zone (TDZ)/Technology Transfer Office (TTO) technical legislation** through university-public collaboration; establish a performance-oriented R&D and awareness culture.

IMPACT IN NUMBERS

25+ YEARS UNIV.-INDUSTRY	300+ INDUSTRIAL R&D PROJECTS	100+ ORGANISATIONS ADVISED	~30 R&D PROJECT MARKETS	3,000+ ENTREPRENEURS TRAINED
100+ PATENT APPLICATIONS	150+ TRADEMARK REGISTRATIONS	4 BOOKS	3 PATENTS	4 SOFTWARE

NOTABLE FIRSTS & SUCCESS STORY

- ★ Through the **Industrial R&D Support Unit** he founded at the Sakarya Chamber of Commerce and Industry, he raised the province to **1st among all provinces (from 38th)** in KOSGEB applications, and from **24th to 8th** in TÜBİTAK TEYDEB. **(2010–2011)**
- ★ At Istanbul Commerce University he created **Turkey's first accredited entrepreneurship curriculum for engineers, equivalent to the KOSGEB Entrepreneurship Programme**; **over 1,000 students** who completed the course earned the Applied Entrepreneurship certificate, many achieving international success. **(2012–2014)**
- ★ He pioneered the establishment of a **KOSGEB-TEKMER (Technology Centre)** at Istanbul Commerce University, creating an ecosystem for academics and entrepreneurs to realise R&D projects. **(2012–2014)**
- ★ He pioneered the founding of an **incubation centre** at Sakarya Technopark and mentored dozens of student/academic projects from idea to commercialisation. **(2011–2013)**
- ★ As founding honorary advisor of the **Sakarya Machinery Manufacturers' Association**, he provided R&D support to regional industry and prepared the feasibility study for the Machinery Specialised Organised Industrial Zone. **(2010–2014)**
- ★ He voluntarily managed Sakarya's **first geographical-indication registrations** (İslama Köfte and Dartılı Keşkek) and secured their international registration. **(2011)**
- ★ **B2Verify** – founder of the UK's first true "deep-link" business verification engine. **(2026)**

PROFESSIONAL & ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

● Founder – B2Verify

London, England · **Jan 2026 – Present**

The UK's first "deep-link" business verification / trust-scoring engine; surfacing risk by cross-analysing the ownership and director networks of millions of companies.

● Founder · Business Planning, Start-up Formation, Business Strategy & Immigration Compliance Adviser – Black Rock Immigration Ltd

East Sussex, England · **Feb 2022 – Aug 2025**

Strategic market-entry and UKVI compliance advisory for investors and tech founders (Innovator Founder, Global Talent, ECAA Turkish Businessperson).

● Founder · Consultant – Ahir R&D Consultancy Inc.

Sakarya, Turkey · **Sep 2012 – Dec 2022**

R&D roadmaps and high-budget manufacturing projects (concept to mass production) for 100+ industrial firms; securing funding from TÜBİTAK, KOSGEB, the Ministry of Industry and Development Agencies; R&D Centre establishment, patent/trademark/quality management, and new-product design–manufacturing consultancy.

● Founder · Consultant – Let's Go To UK Consulting Ltd. (UK–Turkey Trade Collaboration)

Hastings, England · **May 2016 – Feb 2022**

A strategic bridge for SMEs in UK–Turkey trade; import-export compliance and B2B matchmaking.

● Assistant Professor – Mechatronics Engineering · Istanbul Commerce University

Istanbul, Turkey · **Jan 2012 – Sep 2014**

Entrepreneurship & Project Management courses; mentoring students from prototype to commercialisation; industry-focused curriculum development.

● Lecturer & Head of Department – Sakarya Univ. Karasu Vocational School

Sakarya, Turkey · **Jan 2009 – Dec 2011**

Head of the Machinery and Metal Technologies Department; industrial internship/placement programmes; vocational curriculum renewal.

● Research Assistant – Advanced Manufacturing · Sakarya University

Sakarya, Turkey · **Dec 2002 – Dec 2008**

Industrial projects in manufacturing technologies, welding and materials science; TÜBİTAK-supported research and scientific publications.

EDUCATION

2011 PhD – Mechanical Engineering

Sakarya Univ. · UK NARIC equivalence RQF-8

Thesis: High-pressure composite hydrogen storage tanks (SAN-TEZ supported).

2005 MSc – Mechanical Eng. (Welding Tech.)

Sakarya Univ.

Roll-Bond heat exchanger (KOSGEB-supported university–industry).

2002 BSc – Mechanical Engineering

Sakarya Univ. · TOP OF DEPARTMENT (Valedictorian), High Honours

Completed the programme one semester early by taking advanced courses.

BOOKS & PATENTS

Books:

- The Baird Effect: Reinventing Start-ups in the Age of AI (2025, 205 pp. · available in all Amazon stores)
- Girişimcilik Rüyası (The Entrepreneurship Dream) (2016)
- R&D and Innovation Supports (2010) · 1st R&D Project Market (2010)

Patents:

- High-Pressure-Resistant Composite Hydrogen Storage Tank (2012)
- Mis-fuelling Warning and Control System (2009)
- Mobile-Phone Presence Detection Device (2008)

Publications: 16 papers (8 Web of Science) · 42 conference papers.

LEADERSHIP · BOARD MEMBERSHIPS · MENTORSHIP · AWARDS

- ~30 **R&D Project Market coordinations** (2009–2018) – Exporters' Associations (İKMİB, AKİB, OAIİB), Chambers of Commerce and Industry, NGOs, universities and technoparks.
- Applied training for **3,000+ engineers and entrepreneurs**; seminars and project mentoring.
- **TÜBİTAK BİGG** – innovation mentor and project-evaluation juror (2014–2021); one-to-one mentoring of 50+ entrepreneurs.
- Member of the **ISTKA** Project Evaluation Board; member of the Rural Development Projects Evaluation Board, Sakarya Provincial Directorate of Agriculture.
- **SAN-TEZ** doctoral research grant (2009) – resulted in a patent and commercialisation.
- **KOSGEB R&D Innovation grant** (2003) through industry collaboration within his MSc thesis; **Top of Department, BSc** (2002).

LANGUAGES & CERTIFICATIONS

- **Turkish** – Native · **English** – Professional Proficiency (Trinity College London GESE, ESOL Skills).
- **Teaching:** Highfield L3 Award in Education & Training (RQF) · Health & Safety instructor certificates.
- Finance for Non-Financial Entrepreneurs · International technopark and TTO training.
- 100+ lifelong-learning courses, seminars and certificate programmes · Chamber of Mechanical Engineers (TMMOB) – Member.